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- ✓ Course framework
- ✓ Further explorations
- ✓ Individual student project guide
- ✓ Sample exam questions

AP[®] African American Studies

COURSE AND EXAM DESCRIPTION

Effective
Fall 2024

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Sample Exam Questions

The sample exam questions that follow illustrate the relationship between the course framework and the AP African American Studies Exam and serve as examples of the types of questions that appear on the exam. After the sample questions is a table that shows to which skill and learning objective(s) each question relates. The table also provides the answers to the multiple-choice questions.

Section I: Multiple-Choice

Questions 1 through 3 refer to the following.

Abraham Cresques, Cartographer, Detail of the Mali Empire from the *Catalan Atlas* “Map of the World,” 1375



Art Images via Getty Images

1. Which of the following best captures the significance of Mansa Musa of the Mali Empire as depicted on the map?
 - (A) His royal dress and display of wealth in gold had a widespread impact on African and Middle Eastern fashions and cultures.
 - (B) His portrayal conveyed the importance of West African empires in global exchange networks.
 - (C) His dominance caused trade to redirect from trans-Saharan routes toward the Atlantic Coast.
 - (D) His depiction with foreign merchants demonstrated his territorial expansion to regions in Europe.
2. A Muslim merchant's journey to the Mali Empire in the fourteenth and fifteenth centuries was most likely motivated by
 - (A) a desire to crossbreed powerful North African camels with Central Asian camels
 - (B) an interest in conducting commerce at the crossroads of the Arab, Persian, Indian, and Chinese empires
 - (C) the appeal of lucrative trade with a wealthy and powerful West African empire
 - (D) the possibility of converting people in the Mali Empire to Islam
3. Which of the following best explains the importance of griots to the Mali Empire?
 - (A) They traded with merchants in Timbuktu for manufactured goods, which increased the wealth of the Mali Empire.
 - (B) They served as jurists in the imperial courts of the Mali Empire, which helped to develop a more sophisticated legal system.
 - (C) They served as generals in the army of the Mali Empire and were immortalized in thirteenth-century equestrian figures.
 - (D) They preserved the history and culture of the Mali Empire, which helped to maintain its traditions for generations.

Questions 4 through 7 refer to the following.

Source 1

"I, Juan Garrido, black resident...of this city...appear before Your Mercy and state that I am in need of making a [petition]...a report on how I served Your Majesty in the conquest and pacification of this New Spain, from the time when the Marqués del Valle [Cortés] entered it; and in his company I was present at all the invasions and conquests and pacifications which were carried out, always with the said Marqués, all of which I did at my own expense without being given either salary or allotment of natives...or anything else. As I am married and a resident of this city, where I have always lived; and also as I went with the Marqués...[Cortés] to discover the islands which are in that part of the southern sea [the Pacific] where there was much hunger and privation¹; and also as I went to discover and pacify the islands of...Puerto Rico; and also as I went on the pacification and conquest of the island of Cuba with...

Diego Velázquez; in all these ways for thirty years have I served and continue to serve Your Majesty—for these reasons stated above do I petition Your Mercy. And also because I was the first to have the inspiration to sow maize here in New Spain and to see if it took; I did this and experimented at my own expense.”

Source: Juan Garrido, Petition to Charles V, Holy Roman Emperor and King of Spain, 1538

¹the act of depriving someone of something

Source 2

“Other sources produce a similar litany of incidents that add up to overwhelming evidence of the black presence in the Peruvian Conquest. The first four non-natives to see the Inca capital of Cuzco in 1533 included a black man.... During Manco Inca’s [Incan ruler] 1536 siege of Cuzco, blacks labored to extinguish the fires on the roof of the royal palace.... A force sent from [the island of] Hispaniola to relieve the defenders included 200 Africans with military experience—a veritable squadron of black conquistadors.”

Source: Matthew Restall, historian, *Seven Myths of the Spanish Conquest*, 2003

4. Which of the following best describes the significance of Juan Garrido as a historical figure in African American Studies?
 - (A) He was the first free African to leave what is modern-day Angola and journey to North America on his own.
 - (B) He was the first free African to participate in the political decision-making of the Portuguese royal court.
 - (C) As a free African, he explored what is today the United States before the first enslaved Africans arrived in North America.
 - (D) As a free African, he protested the conditions in which slave traders began forcibly transporting enslaved Africans to Spanish America.
5. Garrido and Restall provide evidence for which of the following statements about Africans in the Americas during the sixteenth century?
 - (A) African soldiers resisted participating in the colonization of the Americas.
 - (B) African conquistadors were responsible for the destruction of the Incan royal palace.
 - (C) Africans engaged in peacekeeping missions between Europeans and Indigenous people.
 - (D) Africans worked in a variety of roles to colonize the Americas during European conquests.
6. Which of the following most directly motivated enslaved *ladinos* to participate in the conquest of the Americas?
 - (A) They could return to Africa and win praise within their communities.
 - (B) They might gain their freedom in return for their participation.
 - (C) They could fight their European enslavers and incite widespread rebellion.
 - (D) They might acquire enslaved Indigenous people with their gains.

7. Which of the following statements best supports the claim that Africans served an important role in colonizing the Americas?
- (A) They were intermediaries who spoke multiple languages.
 - (B) They negotiated with French colonial forces during decolonization.
 - (C) They helped to convert Indigenous people to Christianity.
 - (D) They fought to expand the rights of Indigenous people.

Questions 8 through 10 refer to the following.

“I grew up like a neglected weed,—ignorant of liberty, having no experience of it. Then I was not happy or contented: every time I saw a white man I was afraid of being carried away. I had two sisters carried away in a chain-gang,—one of them left two children. We were always uneasy. Now I’ve been free, I know what a dreadful condition slavery is. I have seen hundreds of escaped slaves, but I never saw one who was willing to go back and be a slave. I have no opportunity to see my friends in my native land.¹ We would rather stay [there], if we could be as free there as we are here. I think slavery is the next thing to hell.”

Source: Harriet Tubman, testimony as compiled in Benjamin Drew’s *A North-Side View of Slavery*, 1856

¹“Native land” refers to Maryland in the United States, where Harriet Tubman was formerly enslaved.

8. Based on the passage, which of the following describes an outcome of escaping to freedom in the North for formerly enslaved people?
- (A) They returned to the South to be with their families because of the harsh climate in the North.
 - (B) They found it difficult to remain in the North because of the limited economic opportunities.
 - (C) They were often forced to leave their loved ones behind in the South.
 - (D) They returned from the North to their native lands in the South because of their limited social mobility.
9. Which of the following broader historical contexts best explains Tubman’s fear of “being carried away”?
- (A) Enslaved African Americans were being sent to Africa by the American Colonization Society to build overseas colonies.
 - (B) Enslaved African Americans believed that resisting slavery would lead to a delay in gaining freedom through the Underground Railroad.
 - (C) Enslaved African Americans were taken from plantations to fight for the Union army during the Civil War.
 - (D) Enslaved African Americans were often forcibly sold by plantation owners as a part of the domestic slave trade.

10. Tubman's testimony was part of a larger effort by abolitionists to highlight which of the following?
- (A) The challenges of life for Black women during segregation
 - (B) The effects of Black Codes on the lives of newly freed African Americans
 - (C) The experiences of enslaved people in order to advance the cause of freedom
 - (D) The claims that African Americans would be unable to integrate into society

Questions 11 through 14 refer to the following.

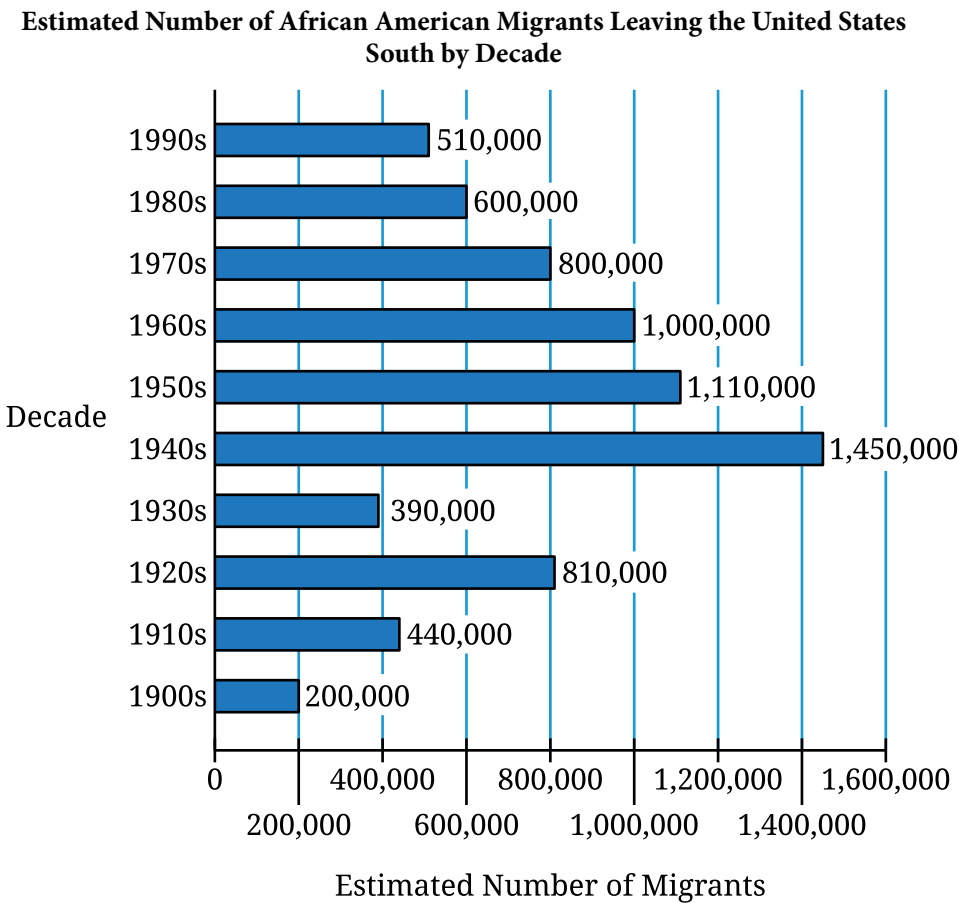
Source 1

Jacob Lawrence, *The Migration Series*, Panel 1, Painted Between 1940 and 1941



© 2022 The Jacob and Gwendolyn Knight Lawrence Foundation, Seattle / Artists Rights Society (ARS), New York. Photo credit: © Phillips Collection / Acquired 1942 / Bridgeman Images

Source 2



Adapted from James N. Gregory, America's Great Migrations Project

11. Which of the following best describes a significant purpose of Lawrence's painting?
- (A) To depict the scale of African American movement to the North, Midwest, and West of the United States
 - (B) To capture the experiences of African American families returning to the southern states
 - (C) To illustrate the traumatic experience of African Americans' forced relocation after Reconstruction
 - (D) To highlight the challenges of the segregation African Americans faced while traveling on public transportation

12. Which of the following statements about Black migration during the 1920s and 1940s does the chart best support?
- (A) The realities of urban life in northern cities led to a sustained decline in migrants leaving the South.
 - (B) The availability of factory jobs in the North led to an eventual increase in migrants leaving the South.
 - (C) The advances made by the Civil Rights movement led to a reduction in the number of migrants leaving the South.
 - (D) The appeal of the Harlem Renaissance led to a substantial increase in migrants leaving the South.
13. Which of the following most directly contributed to the migration of African Americans in the late nineteenth and early twentieth centuries?
- (A) Publications in African American newspapers that denounced racial oppression
 - (B) The constant threat of racial violence throughout the Jim Crow South
 - (C) The end of segregation on railroad passenger cars and interstate bus lines
 - (D) Job shortages that resulted from confiscation of plantations in the South
14. Which of the following describes an effect of both the event depicted in the painting and a trend shown in the chart?
- (A) Racial tensions in the South decreased as employers supported the migration of Black laborers from the region.
 - (B) African Americans' communities became predominantly rural as they relocated from cities to farmland.
 - (C) Cities were transformed as African Americans infused the neighborhoods they settled with Black southern culture.
 - (D) African Americans were given equal access to housing in the urban centers of the North, Midwest, and West.

Questions 15 through 17 refer to the following.

Lift Every Voice and Sing

Let our rejoicing rise
High as the listening skies,
Let it resound loud as the rolling sea.
Sing a song full of the faith that the dark past has taught us,
Sing a song full of the hope that the present has brought us.
Facing the rising sun of our new day begun,
Let us march on till victory is won....

Have not our weary feet
Come to the place for which our fathers sighed?
We have come over a way that with tears has been watered,
We have come, treading our path through the blood of the slaughtered,
Out from the gloomy past,
Till now we stand at last.

Source: James Weldon Johnson, hymn set to music, originally written as a poem, 1900

15. Which of the following best describes Johnson's purpose in writing "Lift Every Voice and Sing"?
- (A) Johnson wanted to illuminate the dehumanization African Americans endured under enslavement to highlight the nation's tumultuous past.
 - (B) Johnson sought to call attention to widespread anti-Black sentiment in the United States in order to further demands for federal civil rights legislation.
 - (C) Johnson sought to celebrate the perseverance and contributions of African Americans after a long period of oppression.
 - (D) Johnson wanted to highlight the struggles African Americans faced while indicating that these struggles were over.
16. The significance of "Lift Every Voice and Sing" in the early twentieth century can be best explained as
- (A) a call for African Americans to join in the war effort and secure a victory abroad
 - (B) an example of African Americans developing their own identity and honoring their heritage
 - (C) a demonstration that African Americans were willing to protest unfair labor conditions
 - (D) an illustration of using artistic works to generate widespread support for the cause of abolition
17. Which of the following claims can best be made about spirituals and hymns such as "Lift Every Voice and Sing"?
- (A) They conveyed the assertion that African Americans should be accepted as equals.
 - (B) They encouraged African Americans to use music as a means of assimilation.
 - (C) They offered uplifting messages of redemption and deliverance.
 - (D) They were used to promote solidarity between African Americans and other oppressed groups.

Questions 18 through 20 refer to the following.

Bus Station with “Colored Waiting Room” Sign, Durham, North Carolina, 1940



Universal History Archive/Universal Images Group via Getty Images

18. Which of the following best describes the legal basis for segregated waiting rooms like the one depicted in the image?
- (A) Presidential executive orders focused on equal economic opportunity rather than the segregation of public facilities.
 - (B) The Supreme Court ruled in *Plessy v. Ferguson* that segregated facilities created by state laws were constitutional.
 - (C) The Supreme Court ruling in *Brown v. Board of Education* addressed segregation in education but not in transportation.
 - (D) Amendments to the United States Constitution gave the states broad powers to manage public infrastructure.
19. Which of the following best describes how African Americans responded to insufficient transportation options during segregation?
- (A) African Americans prioritized economic integration over their access to public services.
 - (B) African Americans moved from rural areas to major cities for access to better transportation options.
 - (C) African Americans elected congressional representatives who would enact changes in federal policies.
 - (D) African Americans established taxi services and bus companies to serve their communities.

20. Which of the following most directly ended widespread segregation in the South?
- (A) The landmark piece of federal legislation that outlawed discriminatory practices in voting
 - (B) Peaceful sit-ins like those at lunch counters in the South in the 1960s
 - (C) Nonviolent marches such as the March on Washington in 1963
 - (D) The federal act that prohibited discrimination on the basis of race, color, and religion

Section II: Free-Response

The following are examples of the kinds of free-response questions found on the exam.

1. Short-Answer Question, Visual Source

Great Zimbabwe's Walls and Stone Enclosures, Twelfth to Fifteenth Century



Robin Smith/Getty Images

- (A) Describe one important cultural or political function of the structures in the image.
- (B) Describe one economic, cultural, or social difference between Great Zimbabwe and another African empire from the same period.
- (C) Explain one way the religious or cultural practices of an African empire or its people changed after 1500 CE.

2. Short-Answer Question, Text-Based Source

“The right of the Afro-American to vote and hold office remains in the Federal Constitution, but is destroyed in the constitution of the Southern states. Having destroyed the citizenship of the man, they are now trying to destroy the manhood of the citizen. All their laws are shaped to this end, school laws, railroad car regulations, those governing labor liens on crops, every device is adopted to make slaves of free men and rob them of their wages. Whenever a malicious law is violated in any parts, any farmer, any railroad conductor, or merchant can call together a posse of his neighbors and punish even with death the black man who resists and the legal authorities sanction what is done by failing to prosecute and punish the murders. The Repeal of the Civil Rights Law removed their last barrier and the black man’s last bulwark and refuge. The rule of the mob is absolute.”

Source: Ida B. Wells-Barnett, “Lynch Law in All its Phases,” delivered at Tremont Temple, Boston, Massachusetts, 1893

- (A) Describe the broader historical context of Wells-Barnett’s speech.
- (B) Describe one piece of evidence Wells-Barnett provides in her speech to support her claim that Southern states were destroying the rights of African Americans.
- (C) Describe a strategy used by African Americans in the late nineteenth and early twentieth century to promote racial uplift.
- (D) Explain how the discriminatory practices described in the speech were challenged by African American activists in the second half of the twentieth century.

3. Short-Answer Question, No Source

- (A) African Americans are part of the larger African diaspora. While African Americans define their experiences as distinct from those of Africans, the idea of an African diaspora has influenced Afro-descended communities throughout the Americas. Describe one specific example of a freedom movement or practice that has been influenced by the idea of an African diaspora.
- (B) Using a specific example of a work of art, a piece of literature, or music, explain how African American artistic expression emerged in response to, or in celebration of, the idea of an African diaspora.
- (C) Explain how connections to the African diaspora have shaped the lives of Afro-descended communities.

4. Document-Based Question

Explain how African Americans' experiences have shaped Black spirituality and/or faith traditions.

In your response you should do the following:

- Respond to the prompt with a defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.
- Describe a broader historical or disciplinary context relevant to the topic of the prompt.
- Support an argument in response to the prompt using at least three of the sources.
- Use at least one additional piece of specific evidence (beyond the evidence found in the sources) relevant to your argument.
- For at least two sources, explain how or why the perspective, purpose, context, and/or audience for each source is relevant to your argument.
- Reference or cite the sources you use in your argument. You can reference or cite the source letter, title, or author.

Source A: Louisiana Code Noir (Black Code), 1724

“II. Makes it imperative on masters to impart religious instruction to their slaves.

III. Permits the exercise of the Roman Catholic creed only. Every other mode of worship is prohibited.

IV. Negroes placed under the direction or supervision of any other person than a Catholic, are liable to confiscation.

V. Sundays and holidays are to be strictly observed. All negroes found at work on these days are to be confiscated.

VI. We forbid our white subjects, of both sexes, to marry with the blacks, under the penalty of being fined and subjected to some other arbitrary punishment. We forbid all curates, priests, or missionaries of our secular or regular clergy, and even our chaplains in our navy to sanction such marriages.”

Source: Articles II–VI from the Louisiana Slave Code (Code Noir, or Black Code), 1724

Source B: An Address to the Slaves in the United States, 1843

“The divine commandments you are in duty bound to reverence and obey. If you do not obey them, you will surely meet with the displeasure of the Almighty. He requires you to love him supremely, and your neighbor as yourself...to search the Scriptures—and bring up your children with respect for his laws, and to worship no other God but him. But slavery sets all these at nought, and hurls defiance in the face of Jehovah. The forlorn condition in which you are placed, does not destroy your moral obligation to God. You are not certain of heaven, because you suffer yourselves to remain in a state of slavery, where you cannot obey the commandments of the Sovereign of the universe....

NEITHER GOD, NOR ANGELS, OR JUST MEN, COMMAND YOU TO SUFFER FOR A SINGLE MOMENT. THEREFORE IT IS YOUR SOLEMN AND IMPERATIVE DUTY TO USE EVERY MEANS, BOTH MORAL, INTELLECTUAL, AND PHYSICAL THAT PROMISES SUCCESS....

Brethren, it is as wrong for your lordly oppressors to keep you in slavery, as it was for the man thief to steal our ancestors from the coast of Africa. You should therefore now use the same manner of resistance, as would have been just in our ancestors.... The humblest peasant is as free in the sight of God as the proudest monarch.... Liberty is a spirit sent out from God.”

Source: Henry Highland Garnet, “Address to the Slaves of the United States,” delivered at the National Convention of Colored Citizens, Buffalo, New York, 1843

Source C: Address to the National Catholic Conference, 1961

“I submit...that the nonviolent movement...

1. is based upon and motivated by love;
2. attempts to serve God and mankind;
3. strives toward what we call the beloved community.

This is religion. This is applied religion. I think it has worked for me and I think it has worked for you and I think it is the work of our Church....

After I had been arrested from a picket line about three weeks ago, I jotted down the following note, with this meeting in mind:

If the policeman had acknowledged the God within each of the students with whom I was arrested last night, would he have put us in jail? Or would he have gone into the store we were picketing and tried to persuade the manager to hire Negroes and to treat all people fairly?...

The students have chosen non-violence as a technique.... It was a responsible choice, I think. We have decided that if there is to be suffering in this revolution...we will take the suffering upon ourselves and never inflict it upon our fellow man, because we respect him and recognize the God within him....

Finally, this movement has been called one of passive resistance. But it is not that at all. Rather it might be called one of active insistence. In regard to our own roles and the role of our Church, I think we need to understand that this is a question of *real* love of man and love of God.”

Source: Diane Nash, Civil Rights activist, “Address to the National Catholic Conference for Interracial Justice,” Detroit, Michigan, 1961

Source D: Muhammad Ali in Mecca, 1972



Bettmann/Contributor

Muhammad Ali, former heavyweight champion of the world, prays inside the Holy Mosque in Mecca during his New Year’s pilgrimage to the spiritual center of the Muslim world.

Source E: Young Black Adults Less Protestant than Their Elders, 2021

Younger Black Americans Less Connected to Black Churches than Older Generations

Percent of Black Americans Who...

	Attend a Congregation That Is...		
	Black	White/Other Race or Multiracial	Seldom/Never Attend
Generation Z (1997-2012)	29%	23%	46%
Millennial (1981-1996)	27%	23%	49%
Generation X (1965-1980)	36%	24%	39%
Baby Boomer (1946-1964)	46%	23%	31%
Silent Generation (1928-1945)	49%	25%	26%

Adapted from table created by Pew Research Center, 2021

Answer Key and Question Alignment to Course Framework

Multiple-Choice Question	Answer	Skill	Learning Objective	Essential Knowledge
1	B	2C	1.5.B	1.5.B.1
2	C	1C	1.5.B	1.5.B.3
3	D	1A	1.6.A	1.6.A.2
4	C	1D	2.1.B	2.1.B.2
5	D	2A	2.1.A	2.1.A.1
6	B	1A	2.1.B	2.1.B.1
7	A	3B	2.1.A	2.1.A.2
8	C	2A	2.20.A*	2.20.A.3*
9	D	2B	2.5.C	2.5.C.3
10	C	1C	2.5.B	2.5.B.2
11	A	2B	3.16.A	3.16.A.1
12	B	2D	3.16.A	3.16.A.2
13	B	1C	3.6.B	3.6.B.2
14	C	1C	3.16.B	3.16.B.1
15	C	2B	3.11.A	3.11.A.1
16	B	2C	3.8.A	3.8.A.3
17	C	3B	2.9.C	2.9.C.1
18	B	2B	3.4.A	3.4.A.4
19	D	1A	4.5.A	4.5.A.6
20	D	1C	4.6.C	4.6.C.1

*Skills-focused question. The Learning Objective and Essential Knowledge correspond to the source.

Free-Response Question	Question Type	Skills	Learning Objectives	Essential Knowledge
1	Short-Answer Question, Visual Source	1A, 1B, 1C, 2B, 3A, 3B	1.5.A, 1.5.B, 1.5.C, 1.6.A, 1.7.A, 1.8.A, 1.8.B, 1.9.A, 1.9.C, 1.11.A, 1.11.B	1.5.A.1, 1.5.A.2, 1.5.B.1, 1.5.C.1, 1.6.A.1, 1.7.A.1, 1.8.A.1, 1.8.A.2, 1.8.A.3, 1.8.B.1, 1.8.B.2, 1.8.B.3, 1.9.A.1, 1.9.A.2, 1.9.C.2, 1.11.A.1, 1.11.A.2, 1.11.B.1
2	Short-Answer Question, Text Source	1A, 1C, 2A, 2B, 3A, 3B	3.1.A, 3.1.B, 3.3.A, 3.3.B, 3.4.A, 3.5.A, 3.5.B, 3.7.A, 3.8.A, 3.8.B, 3.9.A, 3.10.A, 3.10.B, 3.11.A, 3.12.A, 3.13.A, 3.14.A, 3.14.B, 3.15.A, 3.15.B, 3.18.A, 3.18.B, 4.3.A, 4.3.B, 4.4.A, 4.4.B, 4.4.C, 4.5.A, 4.5.B, 4.6.A, 4.6.B, 4.6.C, 4.7.A, 4.7.B, 4.8.A, 4.8.B, 4.9.A, 4.9.B, 4.10.A, 4.10.B, 4.11.A, 4.15.A, 4.15.B	3.1.A.1, 3.1.A.2, 3.1.A.3, 3.1.A.4, 3.1.B.1, 3.1.B.2, 3.3.A.1, 3.3.A.2, 3.3.B.1, 3.3.B.2, 3.3.B.3, 3.3.B.4, 3.4.A.1, 3.4.A.2, 3.4.A.3, 3.4.A.4, 3.5.A.1, 3.5.A.2, 3.5.B.1, 3.5.B.3, 3.7.A.1, 3.7.A.2, 3.7.A.3, 3.8.A.1, 3.8.A.3, 3.8.A.4, 3.8.B.1, 3.8.B.2, 3.8.B.3, 3.9.A.1, 3.9.A.2, 3.9.A.3, 3.9.A.4, 3.10.A.1, 3.10.A.2, 3.10.B.1, 3.11.A.1, 3.11.A.2, 3.11.A.3, 3.12.A.1, 3.13.A.1, 3.13.B.1, 3.14.B.1, 3.15.A.1, 3.15.B.1, 3.18.A.1, 3.18.B.1, 4.3.A.1, 4.3.A.2, 4.3.B.1, 4.4.A.1, 4.4.B.1, 4.4.C.1, 4.4.C.2, 4.5.A.1, 4.5.A.3, 4.5.A.4, 4.6.A.1, 4.6.A.2, 4.6.B.1, 4.6.C.1, 4.6.C.2, 4.7.A.1, 4.7.B.1, 4.8.A.1, 4.8.B.1, 4.8.B.2, 4.8.B.3, 4.9.A.1, 4.9.B.1, 4.10.A.1, 4.10.B.1, 4.11.A.1, 4.15.A.1, 4.15.A.2, 4.15.A.3, 4.15.B.1, 4.15.B.2

Free-Response Question	Question Type	Skills	Learning Objectives	Essential Knowledge
3	Short-Answer Question, No Source	1A, 1B, 1C, 3A, 3B	1.7.A, 1.9.C, 2.9.A, 2.9.B, 2.9.C, 2.11.A, 2.12.A, 2.12.C, 2.13.B, 2.15.A, 2.15.B, 2.18.A, 2.20.A, 2.21.A, 3.11.A, 3.13.A, 3.14.A, 3.15.A, 3.15.B, 3.17.B, 3.18.A, 3.18.B 4.1.A, 4.1.B, 4.2.A, 4.2.B, 4.2.C, 4.10.A, 4.12.B, 4.12.C, 4.17.A	1.7.A.1, 1.7.A.3, 1.9.C.1, 1.9.C.2, 2.9.A.1, 2.9.A.2, 2.9.A.3, 2.9.B.1, 2.9.B.2, 2.9.C.1, 2.9.C.2, 2.9.C.3, 2.9.C.4, 2.11.A.1, 2.11.A.2, 2.11.A.3, 2.11.A.4, 2.12.A.1, 2.12.A.2, 2.12.A.5, 2.12.C.1, 2.12.C.2, 2.13.B.1, 2.13.B.2, 2.13.B.3, 2.15.A.1, 2.15.A.2, 2.15.A.3, 2.15.A.4, 2.15.B.1, 2.18.A.1, 2.18.A.2, 2.20.A.1, 2.20.A.2, 2.20.A.3, 2.21.A.1, 3.11.A.1, 3.13.A.1, 3.14.A.1, 3.15.A.1, 3.15.B.1, 3.17.B.1, 3.17.B.2, 3.17.B.3, 3.18.A.1, 3.18.B.1, 4.1.A.1, 4.1.A.2, 4.1.A.3, 4.1.B.1, 4.1.B.2, 4.2.A.1, 4.2.B.1, 4.2.C.1, 4.2.C.2, 4.10.A.1, 4.10.A.2, 4.12.B.1, 4.12.B.2, 4.12.C.1, 4.12.C.2, 4.17.A.1
4	Document-Based Question	3A, 3B, 3C, 3D, 3E	1.7.A, 1.9.C, 2.5.B, 2.7.A, 2.7.B, 2.9.B, 2.9.C, 2.13.A, 2.13.B, 2.19.A, 3.9.A, 3.10.B, 4.4.A, 4.6.A, 4.7.A, 4.8.B, 4.9.A, 4.9.B, 4.16.B	1.7.A.1, 1.7.A.2, 1.7.A.3, 1.9.C.1, 1.9.C.2, 2.5.B.1, 2.5.B.2, 2.7.A.1, 2.7.A.2, 2.7.A.3, 2.7.A.4, 2.7.B.1, 2.7.B.2, 2.7.B.3, 2.9.B.1, 2.9.B.2, 2.9.C.1, 2.9.C.2, 2.9.C.3, 2.9.C.4, 2.13.A.3, 2.13.B.5, 2.19.A.2, 3.9.A.3, 3.9.A.4, 3.10.B.4, 4.4.A.1, 4.6.A.1, 4.7.A.1, 4.7.A.2, 4.7.A.3, 4.7.A.4, 4.8.B.1, 4.8.B.2, 4.9.A.1, 4.9.A.2, 4.9.B.1, 4.9.B.2, 4.9.B.3, 4.9.B.4, 4.16.B.1, 4.16.B.2, 4.16.B.3, 4.19.B.1, 4.19.B.2



Scoring Guidelines

Question 1: Short-Answer Question, Visual Source

Great Zimbabwe's Walls and Stone Enclosures, Twelfth to Fifteenth Century



Robin Smith/Getty Images

- (A) Describe one important cultural or political function of the structures in the image.
- (B) Describe one economic, cultural, or social difference between Great Zimbabwe and another African empire from the same period.
- (C) Explain one way the religious or cultural practices of an African empire or its people changed after 1500 CE.

Scoring Guideline for Question 1: Short-Answer Question, Visual Source 3 points

(A) Describe one important cultural or political function of the structures in the image.

1 point

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Important political functions of the structure of the Great Zimbabwe such as:
 - ♦ Military defense
 - ♦ Protection of inhabitants
 - ♦ Housed the seat of power or rulers
- Important cultural functions of the structure of the Great Zimbabwe such as:
 - ♦ Religious center for the Shona people
 - ♦ Center for celebrations

(B) Describe one economic, cultural, or social difference between Great Zimbabwe and another African empire from the same period. 1 point

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- An economic difference between Great Zimbabwe and another African empire from the same period such as:
 - ♦ Great Zimbabwe earned its wealth from trade on the Swahili coast and the Indian Ocean, while Ghana traded with North Africa and the Mediterranean.
 - ♦ Great Zimbabwe earned its wealth by trading in gold, ivory, and cattle resources, while the Songhai Empire traded in gold, kola nuts, and enslaved people.
 - ♦ Great Zimbabwe earned its wealth by trading in gold, ivory, and cattle resources, while the Mali Empire traded in gold, kola nuts, and enslaved people.
- A cultural difference between Great Zimbabwe and another African empire from the same period such as:
 - ♦ Great Zimbabwe focused on trade, as compared to the Mali focus on learning in the city of Timbuktu.
- A social difference between Great Zimbabwe and another African empire from the same period such as:
 - ♦ Great Zimbabwe declined due to deforestation and overpopulation, as compared to the Songhai, which fell to invasion.

(C) Explain one way the religious or cultural practices of an African empire or its people changed after 1500 CE. 1 point

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- One way religious practices of an African empire or its people changed after 1500 such as:
 - ♦ Introduction of Catholicism to Kongo
 - ♦ Widespread conversion to Christianity
 - ♦ Widespread conversion to Islam
 - ♦ Blending of Indigenous spiritual practices with Christianity in the Americas

Total for (Question 1) 3 points

Question 2: Short-Answer Question, Text-Based Source

“The right of the Afro-American to vote and hold office remains in the Federal Constitution, but is destroyed in the constitution of the Southern states. Having destroyed the citizenship of the man, they are now trying to destroy the manhood of the citizen. All their laws are shaped to this end, school laws, railroad car regulations, those governing labor liens on crops, every device is adopted to make slaves of free men and rob them of their wages. Whenever a malicious law is violated in any parts, any farmer, any railroad conductor, or merchant can call together a posse of his neighbors and punish even with death the black man who resists and the legal authorities sanction what is done by failing to prosecute and punish the murders. The Repeal of the Civil Rights Law removed their last barrier and the black man’s last bulwark and refuge. The rule of the mob is absolute.”

Source: Ida B. Wells-Barnett, “Lynch Law in All its Phases,” delivered at Tremont Temple, Boston, Massachusetts, 1893

- (A) Describe the broader historical context of Wells-Barnett’s speech.
- (B) Describe one piece of evidence Wells-Barnett provides in her speech to support her claim that Southern states were destroying the rights of African Americans.
- (C) Describe a strategy used by African Americans in the late nineteenth and early twentieth century to promote racial uplift.
- (D) Explain how the discriminatory practices described in the speech were challenged by African American activists in the second half of the twentieth century.

Scoring Guideline for Question 2: Short-Answer Question, Text-Based Source

4 points

(A) Describe the broader historical context of Wells-Barnett’s speech.

1 point

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- This period was known as the nadir, as it was the point when African Americans had no protection and endured extreme racial violence.
- At this time, African Americans were being disenfranchised and were limited in their ability to advance economically and socially.
- During this period, Southern states were implementing segregation laws and violating the newly established rights of African Americans.

(B) Describe one piece of evidence Wells-Barnett provides in her speech to support her claim that Southern states were destroying the rights of African Americans.

1 point

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- A piece of evidence that Wells-Barnett provides to support her claim that Southern states were destroying the rights of African Americans was her reference to African Americans having the right to vote federally but being impeded by laws in Southern states.
- A piece of evidence that Wells-Barnett references are the labor liens on crops. Through sharecropping, white landowners provided land and equipment to African Americans in exchange for a large share of the crops, which made economic advancement difficult.
- A piece of evidence that Wells-Barnett provides to support her claim includes the railroad car regulations in Southern states that segregated where white and Black passengers could sit.

(C) Describe a strategy used by African Americans in the late nineteenth and early twentieth century to promote racial uplift. 1 point

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- During segregation, African Americans created businesses to meet the needs of their communities.
- Black women activists founded organizations like the National Association of Colored Women to promote the well-being and advancement of women and girls.
- African Americans promoted safe spaces by creating their own religious institutions such as the African Methodist Episcopal Church.

(D) Explain how the discriminatory practices described in the speech were challenged by African American activists in the second half of the twentieth century. 1 point

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Civil Rights activists challenged discriminatory practices in voting through nonviolent campaigns such as the Mississippi Freedom Summer Project. The campaign included voter registration drives and Freedom Schools.
- African American activists challenged the discriminatory practices in education described by taking legal actions against Black students' unequal access to education. The NAACP supported the cases of families who believed their children were not receiving a quality education, and the Supreme Court decided that the education that African American students received was unconstitutional, which began a campaign of integration.
- Members of the Black Panther Party for Self-Defense challenged discrimination by promoting their right to bear arms in cases of self-defense. In their ten-point program, the Black Panther Party advocated for ending police brutality by organizing community groups to monitor interactions between the community and law enforcement.

Total for (Question 2) 4 points

Question 3: Short-Answer Question, No source

- (A) African Americans are part of the larger African diaspora. While African Americans define their experiences as distinct from those of Africans, the idea of an African diaspora has influenced Afro-descended communities throughout the Americas. Describe one specific example of a freedom movement or practice that has been influenced by the idea of an African diaspora.
- (B) Using a specific example of a work of art, a piece of literature, or music, explain how African American artistic expression emerged in response to, or in celebration of, the idea of an African diaspora.
- (C) Explain how connections to the African diaspora have shaped the lives of Afro-descended communities.

Scoring Guideline for Question 3: Short-Answer Question, No Source 3 points

- (A) Describe one specific example of a freedom movement or practice that has been influenced by the idea of an African diaspora. 1 point**

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- The creation of maroon communities of Afro-descendants in the Americas
- The Stono Rebellion was a slave revolt that emerged from a maroon community.
- The Louisiana Slave Revolt of 1811 was inspired by the Haitian Revolution.
- Marcus Garvey's Back-to-Africa movement sought to repatriate African Americans to Africa.

- (B) Using a specific example of a work of art, a piece of literature, or music, explain how African American artistic expression emerged in response to, or in celebration of, the idea of an African diaspora. 1 point**

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- Artist Bisa Butler uses African American quilt-making traditions combined with cultural elements of multiple African regions to draw connections between African and African American heritage.
- Countee Cullen's poem "Heritage" celebrates African Americans' African heritage.
- Spirituals reflect African American religious traditions with African rhythmic and performative elements.
- Afro-Cuban poet Nicolas Guillen supported African Americans during the Civil Rights movement through his poem "Little Rock."

- (C) Explain how connections to the African diaspora have shaped the lives of Afro-descended communities. 1 point**

Examples that earn this point include the following:

- The Stono Rebellion was an attempt by Africans in South Carolina to escape slavery and find refuge with other Africans in Spanish Florida.
- The Haitian Revolution influenced revolts such as the Louisiana Slave Revolt of 1811, encouraging members of the diaspora to fight for their freedom.
- Claude McKay, a Jamaican poet, encouraged African Americans to fight back against racial violence and discrimination in his poem "If We Must Die."
- Solidarity between African Americans and Africans brought international attention to Africa's decolonization movements of the 1950s and 1960s.

Total for (Question 3) 3 points

AP African American Studies Source DBQ Rubric (7 points)

Reporting Category	Scoring Criteria	Decision Rules
A. THESIS OR CLAIM (0–1 point)	1 point Responds to the prompt with a defensible thesis or claim that establishes a line of reasoning.	<i>To earn this point, the thesis must make a claim that responds to the prompt rather than restate or rephrase the prompt. The thesis must consist of one or more sentences located in one place, either in the introduction or the conclusion.</i>
B. CONTEXT (0–1 point)	1 point Describes a broader historical or disciplinary context relevant to the topic of the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe broader events, developments, processes, or disciplinary connections that are relevant to the topic of the prompt. The point is not earned for a passing phrase or reference.</i>
C. EVIDENCE (0–3 points)	Evidence from the Sources	<i>To earn one point, the response must accurately describe—rather than simply quote—the content from at least two sources.</i>
	1 point OR 2 points Uses the content of at least two sources to address the topic of the prompt. Supports an argument in response to the prompt using at least three sources.	<i>To earn two points, the response must accurately describe—rather than just quote—the content from at least three sources. In addition, the response must use the content of three sources to support an argument in response to the prompt.</i>
	Evidence Beyond the Sources 1 point Uses at least one additional piece of specific evidence (beyond the evidence found in the sources) relevant to an argument in response to the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must describe the evidence using more than a phrase or reference. This additional piece of evidence must be relevant to an argument in response to the prompt.</i>
D. SOURCE USE (0–1 point)	1 point For at least two sources, explains how or why the perspective, purpose, context, and/or audience of each source is relevant to an argument.	<i>To earn this point, the response must explain how or why (rather than simply identify) the perspective, purpose, context, or audience of each source (for at least two sources) is relevant to an argument about the prompt.</i>
E. REASONING (0–1 point)	1 point Uses reasoning (e.g., causation, comparison, change or continuity across time or geography) to set up an argument that addresses the prompt.	<i>To earn this point, the response must demonstrate the use of reasoning to frame or structure an argument, even if the reasoning is uneven or the evidence lacks specificity.</i>